

The Cloak

● is the grown-up · ○ is you · ●○ is together

● Makkah was hot that year, and the Kaaba was broken. A flood had come down the valley and cracked the walls, so the families of the city pulled the old stones out to build it up again, higher than before.

○ *Who was building it?*

● Everyone. Every family took a wall. That was the point — nobody was going to let another family say they had built the House of God on their own. It went up fast.

● Then they came to the Black Stone.

○ *What is the Black Stone?*

● The stone set into the corner of the Kaaba. It is the oldest thing there, older than anyone could count back. It had to go into the new wall, and one man would carry it, and one family would be the family who did.

○ *Everybody wanted to be them.*

● Everybody wanted to be them. So for four days, nobody worked. Men sat in the shade with their arms folded and would not go near the wall. Then one family carried a bowl of blood into the courtyard and put their hands in it, which was how you said you would rather die than give way.

○ *Over a stone?*

● Over who they were.

○ *Would you have given it up? Say it out loud before we go on.*

● Nobody there did. They argued until an old man said: let the next person who walks through that gate settle it. Everyone agreed, because nobody
by saying it would be